# NCE Printable Study Planner and Test-Day Kit

Schedules, trackers, and checklists to take you from day one to test day

**Free Reader Bonus #3 for NCE Exam Prep 2026–2027**

**Keystone Test Prep Team**

**NCE Printable Study Planner and Test-Day Kit**

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Exam facts in this bonus match NCE Exam Prep 2026–2027, which draws on NBCC's official documents. Testing policies change. Always confirm rules, fees, and dates in the most recent official materials.

## How to Use This Planner

This planner turns the study system from NCE Exam Prep 2026–2027 into pages you can print and fill in. Start by choosing a schedule. Then print one weekly planner for each week of study and keep a running weak-spot tracker beside you every time you answer practice questions. In the final week, switch to the seven-day countdown and the test-day checklists.

- **Print what you need.** Print the weekly planner and tracker pages as many times as you like.
- **Tick as you go.** Every schedule and checklist has a box to check, so you can see your progress at a glance.
- **Keep it honest.** Record actual study time, not planned time. Your data guides your decisions.

## Step 1: Choose Your Schedule

| Your Situation | Recommended Schedule |
|---|---|
| Finishing a program and working part-time; diagnostic score of 10 or below | 12-week |
| Working full-time; diagnostic score between 11 and 15 | 8-week or 12-week |
| Strong recent coursework; diagnostic score of 16 or higher | 8-week |
| Retaking after a close miss, with domain feedback in hand | 4-week or 8-week |
| Retaking after a wide miss | 12-week |
| Less than 4 weeks available | Consider moving the date; if not possible, use the 4-week plan and focus on the highest-weight domains |

Plan for about 8 to 10 hours per week on the 12-week schedule, 10 to 12 hours on the 8-week schedule, and 15 to 20 hours on the 4-week schedule.

## The 12-Week Schedule

| Week | Main Focus | Learn and Test | Fix and Lock In | Approx. Hours | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Orientation | Diagnostic quiz; read Chapters 1–3; set up tracker | Choose your test date and exam version | 6–8 | ☐ |
| 2 | Domain 1: Professional Development & Counselor Self-Awareness | Read Chapter 4 using the Learn routine | Review diagnostic misses; begin tracker | 8–10 | ☐ |
| 3 | Domain 1 completion; Domain 2 begins | Chapter 4 review questions; begin Chapter 5 | Fix Chapter 4 errors; Lock In Chapter 1 facts | 8–10 | ☐ |
| 4 | Domain 2: Intake & Assessment | Continue Chapter 5, including statistics and diagnosis | Blank-page recall on Chapter 4 | 9–10 | ☐ |
| 5 | Domain 2 completion | Chapter 5 review questions; Appendix C and D review | Fix Chapter 5 errors; mixed set of 20 questions from Chapters 4–5 | 9–10 | ☐ |
| 6 | Domain 3: Treatment Planning & Continuity of Care | Read Chapter 6; review questions | Fix Chapter 6 errors; Lock In Domain 1 | 8–10 | ☐ |
| 7 | Domain 4: Provision of Counseling Interventions (part 1) | Read first half of Chapter 7: core skills, theories | Lock In Domain 2 tracker items | 9–10 | ☐ |
| 8 | Domain 4 completion | Second half of Chapter 7: groups, family, career, crisis; review questions | Fix Chapter 7 errors | 9–10 | ☐ |
| 9 | Practice Exam A and Domain 5 | Take Practice Exam A under timed conditions; read Chapter 8 | Complete score-analysis table; update tracker | 9–10 | ☐ |
| 10 | Domain 6: Legal & Ethical Compliance | Read Chapter 9; review questions; Appendix B | Fix Practice Exam A and Chapter 9 errors | 9–10 | ☐ |
| 11 | Targeted review and Practice Exam B | Take Practice Exam B; focus on the two weakest domains | Mixed review sets; all Exam Traps boxes | 9–10 | ☐ |

| Week | Main Focus | Learn and Test | Fix and Lock In | Approx. Hours | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | Final stretch | Follow Chapter 11's last-seven-days plan | Light review of tracker, appendices, and Quick Recall boxes | 6–8 | ☐ |

## The 8-Week Schedule

| Week | Main Focus | Learn and Test | Fix and Lock In | Approx. Hours | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Orientation and Domain 1 | Diagnostic quiz; skim Chapters 1–3; read Chapter 4 | Set up tracker; record diagnostic misses | 10–12 | ☐ |
| 2 | Domain 2: Intake & Assessment | Chapter 4 questions; read Chapter 5 | Fix Chapter 4 errors | 11–12 | ☐ |
| 3 | Domain 2 completion and Domain 3 | Chapter 5 questions; read Chapter 6 and its questions | Fix errors; mixed set from Chapters 4–5 | 11–12 | ☐ |
| 4 | Domain 4: Provision of Counseling Interventions | Read Chapter 7; review questions | Fix errors; Lock In Domains 1–2 | 11–12 | ☐ |
| 5 | Domain 5 and Practice Exam A | Read Chapter 8 and its questions; take Practice Exam A | Score-analysis table; update tracker | 11–12 | ☐ |
| 6 | Domain 6: Legal & Ethical Compliance | Read Chapter 9; review questions; Appendix B | Fix Practice Exam A and Chapter 9 errors | 11–12 | ☐ |
| 7 | Targeted review and Practice Exam B | Practice Exam B; study two weakest domains | Mixed review sets; all Exam Traps boxes | 10–12 | ☐ |
| 8 | Final stretch | Chapter 11's last-seven-days plan | Light review only in the final two days | 6–8 | ☐ |

## The 4-Week Schedule

| Week | Main Focus | Learn and Test | Fix and Lock In | Approx. Hours | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Baseline and Domains 1–2 | Diagnostic quiz; skim Chapters 1–3; take Practice Exam A cold; study Chapters 4–5 focused on weak sections | Score-analysis table; build tracker from Practice Exam A | 15–20 | ☐ |
| 2 | Domains 3–4 | Study Chapters 6–7; answer both chapter reviews | Fix errors daily; Lock In Domains 1–2 with Quick Recall boxes | 15–20 | ☐ |
| 3 | Domains 5–6 | Study Chapters 8–9; answer both chapter reviews; Appendix B | Fix errors; mixed sets of 25 questions every other day | 15–20 | ☐ |
| 4 | Practice Exam B and final stretch | Take Practice Exam B early in the week; review weakest areas; follow Chapter 11 | Light review only in the last two days | 10–15 | ☐ |
| Your Situation | Recommended Schedule | ☐ | | | |
| --- | --- | ☐ | | | |
| Finishing a program and working part-time; diagnostic score of 10 or below | 12-week | ☐ | | | |
| Working full-time; diagnostic score between 11 and 15 | 8-week or 12-week | ☐ | | | |
| Strong recent coursework; diagnostic score of 16 or higher | 8-week | ☐ | | | |
| Retaking after a close miss, with domain feedback in hand | 4-week or 8-week | ☐ | | | |

| Week | Main Focus | Learn and Test | Fix and Lock In | Approx. Hours | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Retaking after a wide miss | 12-week | ☐ | | | |
| Less than 4 weeks available | Consider moving the date; if not possible, use the 4-week plan and focus on the highest-weight domains | ☐ | | | |

# Weak-Spot Tracker

| Date | Source | Domain | Topic or Concept | Error Type | What I Believed | What Is Correct | Review Dates | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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Error types: knowledge gap, misread stem, overthinking, real-world habit, distractor trap, confident but wrong. Status: Watch, Improving, Fixed.

## Weak-Spot Tracker (continued)

| Date | Source | Domain | Topic or Concept | Error Type | What I Believed | What Is Correct | Review Dates | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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# Weekly Study Planner

Week of: _____ Target test date: _____ Weeks remaining: _____

| Day | Phase (Learn, Test, Fix, Lock In) | Chapter or Domain | Specific Tasks | Planned Time | Actual Time | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Monday | | | | | | |
| Tuesday | | | | | | |
| Wednesday | | | | | | |
| Thursday | | | | | | |
| Friday | | | | | | |
| Saturday | | | | | | |
| Sunday | | | | | | |

## End-of-Week Review

| Question | My Answer |
|---|---|
| Practice questions answered this week | |
| Percent correct | |
| New tracker entries | |
| Items moved to "Fixed" | |
| Most common error type | |
| Domain needing the most attention next week | |
| One thing that went well | |
| One change for next week | |

# Your Final Seven Days

| Day | Focus | Activities | Time | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 days before | Weak-spot sweep | Review every "Watch" item in your weak-spot tracker; re-read the matching Quick Recall boxes | 2–3 hours | ☐ |
| 6 days before | Highest-weight domains | Review Chapters 7 and 9 Quick Recall and Exam Traps boxes; answer 25 mixed questions from chapter reviews you missed before | 2–3 hours | ☐ |
| 5 days before | Intake and assessment | Review the normal curve, reliability and validity, diagnosis durations, and risk assessment; redraw the normal curve from memory | 2 hours | ☐ |
| 4 days before | Mixed practice | Answer 40 mixed questions under timed conditions; analyze errors and update the tracker | 2–3 hours | ☐ |
| 3 days before | Appendices | Review Appendices A through E: theorists, ethics and law, diagnosis tables, statistics, glossary | 2 hours | ☐ |
| 2 days before | Logistics and light review | Confirm appointment, ID, route or OnVUE setup; review your "Fixed" tracker items briefly | 1–2 hours | ☐ |
| 1 day before | Rest | Light review of one page of notes at most; relax; prepare for the night before | 30 minutes or less | ☐ |

## The Night Before

**Prepare your materials.**

☐ **In-person testing:** two forms of original, unexpired ID, with the first and last name exactly matching your registration. The primary ID must be government-issued with your name, photo, and signature. Lay them out with your keys.

☐ **Online testing:** your government-issued photo ID, a cleared desk and room, a fully charged computer plugged into power, and a completed system check. Remove books, notes, whiteboards, and extra monitors from the room.

**Confirm logistics.**

☐ Check your appointment time and, for in-person testing, the address. Plan to arrive early. Remember that arriving more than 15 minutes late means forfeiting your exam.

☐ For online testing, plan to log in early. Confirm that no one will interrupt you and that pets will be kept out of the room.

☐ Set two alarms.

**Take care of yourself.**

☐ Eat a normal, balanced dinner.

☐ Do something relaxing: a walk, a favorite show, time with someone supportive.

☐ Practice your paced breathing for a few minutes.

☐ If worries come up, write them down and remind yourself that you have prepared.

☐ Go to bed at your usual time.

# Test-Day Checklist

| Before You Leave or Log In | At Check-In | During the Exam | After the Exam |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ Eat a familiar breakfast with protein | ☐ Arrive or log in early (check-in opens up to 30 minutes before) | ☐ Use the 10-minute tutorial to learn the screen and flagging tools | ☐ Complete the short exam evaluation |
| ☐ Drink water; keep caffeine to your usual amount | ☐ Present ID; names must match registration | ☐ Read every stem for the task word | ☐ Receive your unofficial score report (test center) or view it in your Pearson account (online) |
| ☐ Dress in comfortable layers | ☐ Store belongings in the locker (test center) | ☐ Predict before you look; eliminate using safety, ethics, scope, and relevance | ☐ Do not discuss specific exam questions with anyone |
| ☐ Use the restroom before leaving | ☐ Complete the room scan and photos (online) | ☐ Check pacing at about one hour, the halfway point, and three hours | ☐ Rest and do something enjoyable |
| ☐ Bring your IDs and keys; leave notes and phone behind (test center) | ☐ Agree to the nondisclosure agreement within the time allowed | ☐ Flag and move on from hard items; answer every question | ☐ Write down any questions about next steps for your licensure process |
| ☐ Run the system check and clear your desk (online) | ☐ Settle with five slow breaths | ☐ Review flagged items before submitting the first half; then let it go | |

### Your coping script for anxious moments

1. **Notice:** "My heart is racing and I'm rereading the same line. That's anxiety."
2. **Breathe:** three slow breaths, with the exhale longer than the inhale.
3. **Ground:** feel your feet on the floor and your back against the chair.
4. **Reframe:** "This is one question. Some questions don't even count. I can make my best choice and move on."
5. **Act:** read the stem again, word by word, and look for the task word.

## One Small Request

If NCE Exam Prep 2026–2027 has helped you, please consider leaving an honest review on Amazon. To find it, search for the book's title. Share your real opinion, whatever it is. Reviews help other counseling graduates decide whether the book fits how they study.